Incident Response Runbook

Day 8 RAG practice document

1. Severity Levels

Severity 1 incidents cause a major customer-facing outage or critical data loss. Severity 2 incidents cause substantial degradation with a workaround. Severity 3 incidents have limited impact.

2. First Response

The on-call engineer acknowledges a Severity 1 alert within five minutes. Create an incident channel, assign an incident commander, and begin a timeline of important events.

3. Investigation

Check recent deployments, service health, error rates, dependency status, and relevant logs. Compare current metrics with the normal baseline. Avoid making several unrelated changes at once.

4. Mitigation

Prefer the safest action that restores service, such as rolling back a deployment or disabling a faulty feature flag. Communicate customer impact and status at regular intervals.

5. Follow-up

After recovery, publish a post-incident review within two business days. Document root causes, contributing factors, customer impact, and action items with owners and due dates.